

Build an iPhone App with Claude Code

zero coding skills required — the exact workflow from the reel

```
$ learn_to_code --years 4  
$ hire_developers --cost "$$$$"  
$ wait_for_technical_founder --forever
```

None of that is required anymore. What follows is the complete process — every prompt, every command, every screen — to go from an idea to a live App Store app using **Claude Code** as your engineer.

0 Setup (10 minutes, one time)

- Install **Claude Code**: `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code` (needs Node.js 18+)
- Create a free **Expo** account at expo.dev, and install the **Expo Go** app on your iPhone
- An **Apple Developer** account (\$99/yr) — only needed at Step 5, so you can start today without it

1 Let Claude Code set up the project

Open a terminal in an empty folder, run **claude**, and paste:

PROMPT

Set up a new React Native app using Expo for an iPhone + Android app called [YOUR APP NAME].
Use TypeScript. Confirm it runs with `npx expo start` before we continue.

Why this stack: **one code base, both platforms**. Claude Code will install everything, create the project, and fix its own errors as it goes. Just watch it work.

2 Build the simplest version first

PROMPT

Build the simplest possible version of this idea: [DESCRIBE YOUR APP IN 2-3 SENTENCES]. One screen only. No login, no settings, no extras. I want to see it working today.

Then add features *one at a time*:

PROMPT (REPEAT PER FEATURE)

Add one feature: [FEATURE]. Keep everything else unchanged. Show me what to test when done.

Rule that saves weeks: never ask for two features in one prompt. One feature → test on your phone → next feature. This is how you avoid the "everything is broken" spiral.

3 Test live on your phone

```
npx expo start
```

A QR code appears in the terminal. Scan it with your iPhone camera — the app opens inside **Expo Go**, live. Every change Claude makes reloads on your phone in seconds.

4 Claude writes your App Store listing

PROMPT

Write my App Store listing: an app name under 30 characters, a subtitle under 30 characters, a description that sells the outcome (not the features), 100 characters of keywords, and what I should show in 5 screenshots.

Screenshots: take them inside the iOS Simulator (Claude will tell you the exact sizes Apple wants: 6.7" and 5.5" displays), or ask Claude to generate a screenshot script.

5 Submit for review

PROMPT

Prepare this app for App Store submission with EAS. Walk me through eas build and eas submit step by step, including certificates — assume I have never done this before.

- Expo's **EAS** service handles the scary parts (certificates, signing, upload)
- Fill the App Store Connect form with the listing from Step 4
- Review typically takes 24–48 hours. When Apple approves — **your app is live, worldwide.**

The 5 mistakes that stall beginners

- **Building too much before testing** — Step 2's one-feature rule exists for a reason
- **Vague prompts** — "make it better" fails; "make the button full-width and blue" ships
- **Skipping the phone test** — the simulator lies about feel; Expo Go doesn't
- **Fighting errors yourself** — paste the full error back into Claude Code; it fixes its own mess
- **Waiting for the perfect idea** — your first app is for learning the loop, not for glory

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